

Folk Songs





About the Course

Students sing folk songs connected to the time period (1800-1900).

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Intro, Music: Level 1, Music: Level 2, Music: Level 3, Music: Level 4, Music: Level 5

Folk Songs

The purpose of learning folk songs is twofold: to increase students' enjoyment of music and to situate folk music in its historical context in an effort to give students a richer understanding of the times and places that birthed the songs. A musical score is sometimes included for songs, but does not always exactly match the audio used, since folk songs are primarily oral songs and often take many different forms. Studying folk music helps students grow deep roots in our shared heritage and gives insight into historical events from the perspective of the people who were there.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Folk Songs 1 time/week 10 min	Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Intro				
Sol-fa: Musical Games	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Music Appreciation
Music: Level 1				
Sol-fa: Level 1	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 2				
Sol-fa: Level 2	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study Afternoon Listening	
Music: Level 3				
Sol-fa: Level 3 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 4				
Sol-fa: Level 4 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 5				
Sol-fa: Level 5 Afternoon Listening	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Folk Songs



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Our Work: Grade 3



Our Work: Grades 4-6



Our Work: Grades 7-8



Our Work: Grades 9-12



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Folk Songs

∞ [Hymns, Folk Songs, & Spirituals Youtube Playlist](#)

∞ [Hymns, Folk Songs, & Spirituals Spotify Playlist](#)

∞ [Musical Terms Appendix](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Folk Songs

How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the

melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 1

Steal Away

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Like a Bird

→ INTRO

- The word "steal" usually means to take something that isn't yours. Can you think of any other meanings the word has?
- Tell what you think this sentence means: "Let's steal away now and tell them what we saw!"

→ READ & DISCUSS

Our first folk song for the year is called "Steal Away to Jesus." Its history is somewhat debated. Some think that Nat Turner was one of the first to sing it. Others tell the story of Wallace Willis and how the Reverend Alexander Reid heard Willis singing "Steal Away" (and Swing Low, Sweet Chariot) and told the Jubilee Singers, a famous singing group, about his songs in 1871. It's often hard to trace the history of songs that were orally composed and passed along to others!

Like a Bird p.29

∞ Article Link: History Article 1 or History Article 2

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Refer to your Our Work/Music PDF lyrics as you listen.

∞ Music Links: Steal Away YouTube or Steal Away Spotify

★ TEACHER NOTE

Feel free to choose your own version of Steal Away to learn. Just know that the lyrics vary widely, so another audio or video is unlikely to match the words in your Our Work or Music books.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to the term's songs throughout the week!

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 2

Steal Away (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, United States Atlas or a Globe

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the history of "Steal Away"?

→ SING

Listen to the full song, paying attention to the lyrics. Then listen again and hum along.

∞ Music Links: Steal Away YouTube or Steal Away Spotify

→ READ OR VIEW

Steal Away became an enormously popular song across the United States and the world because of the Fisk Jubilee Singers. Fisk University was founded in 1866, right after the Civil War ended with the Emancipation Proclamation. Students who had previously had limited access to higher education because of slavery and poverty flocked to its doors. But a few years later, the school was struggling financially, and many feared it would have to close. However, relief came from an unexpected source—one of the school's leaders organized a group of the school's talented singers and set up a series of concerts. Initially, they sang classical and popular songs familiar to their white audiences, but eventually the students began also singing the spirituals that they had sung during the years they were enslaved. These spirituals, like Steal Away and Swing Low, Sweet Chariot, skyrocketed the Fisk Jubilee Singers and the school to fame, and both still exist today! Read or watch more about the Jubilee Singers and listen to a recording of Swing Low, Sweet Chariot from 1909 with the remaining time!

∞ Article Link: Jubilee Singers Article

or

∞ Video Link: Jubilee Singers Video

• EXTRA HELPINGS

View Extra Helpings page for books, documentaries, and resources on the Jubilee Singers!



Term 1

→ LISTEN (OPTIONAL)

∞ Audio Link: Swing Low, Sweet Chariot

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 3

Steal Away (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, World Map/Globe/Google Maps

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of "Steal Away"?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the full song. Then listen again and try to sing along with the recording when the singers repeat the first four lines.

∞ Music Links: Steal Away YouTube or Steal Away Spotify

→ MAPWORK

The initial group of Jubilee singers disbanded in 1878 after six strenuous years touring across North America and Europe, but a new group came together and began touring again in 1894, singing everywhere from Canada to Kolkata (then Calcutta), from New England to New Zealand.

View the article and map to get a general sense of the choir's tour and look up as many of the places mentioned as time allows. Note that some cities have been renamed.

∞ Article Link: Jubilee Singer Travels (start reading at the paragraph under the map which describes the tour)

WEEK 4 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 4

Steal Away (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of "Steal Away" as you can from memory. Note the spots where you get stuck!

→ INTRO

If you could ask some of the first Jubilee Singers any questions, what would you ask?

→ SING & PRACTICE

∞ Music Links: Steal Away YouTube or Steal Away Spotify

→ LISTEN

Steal Away is a popular choice for many different artists and groups. Listen to a few different renditions of the song (scroll down the playlist to see a few more options).

∞ Music Links: Steal Away Versions

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 5

Wellerman

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, World Atlas/Globe/Google Maps

PREP: For younger students, mark sections of the article on our next folk song's history to read or share with your students. Print off sheet music if desired.

∞ Article Link: Wellerman History

∞ PDF Link: Wellerman Sheet Music

• TERMINOLOGY

Wellerman: ship owned by the Weller brothers coming with supplies

Tonguing: refers to the process of cutting up the whale for oil

Right Whale: species of whale that is now endangered because of the whaling industry so



Term 1

→ RECAP

Sing Steal Away from memory.

→ INTRO

- Do you know any sea shanties? Our next folk song is a sea shanty that tells a story about a whale. While the story is made up, the Weller brothers were real men who founded a whaling base in 1831 on Aotearoa/New Zealand's South Island. A version of the shanty likely became popular a few decades later, before another author/editor developed the lyrics into their current form in the 1960s.
- Locate New Zealand in your atlas or globe and see if you can find Otakou (look on the South Island).

→ LISTEN & READ

Follow along with the lyrics as you listen to the song.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

→ READ

With remaining time, start reading (older students) or sharing (younger students) about the history behind the Wellerman. See Extra Helpings for more on whales, whaling, and the Wellermans.

∞ Article Link: Wellerman History

prevalent in the 19th century.

• IMPORTANT DATE

Weller brothers found their whaling base on the Otago peninsula in New Zealand (1831 AD)

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 6

Wellerman (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or World Atlas

→ RECAP

- Review Steal Away.
- What do you remember about our new folk song?

→ LISTEN

Listen to the song once or twice. Pay attention to the verses, as there are some words that go by quickly! As you begin to catch onto the tune, start singing the chorus with the recording.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman

→ EXPLORE

With remaining time, finish reading (older students) or sharing (younger students) about the history behind the Wellerman, or see Extra Helpings for more on whales, whaling, and the Wellermans.

∞ Article Link: Wellerman History

WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 7

Wellerman (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum (or sing?) the Wellerman's chorus?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the song once through and mark any sections that you know you don't know well. Then listen again and pause the video after each line of the verses to echo it back.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman

→ ILLUSTRATE (OPTIONAL)



Term 1

With any remaining time or in the afternoon, sketch an illustration to go with this song. (One idea: look up pictures of a right whale and draw a diagram.)

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 8

Wellerman (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite as many of the words (or sing as much of the song) as you can from memory.

→ SING

Continue working on the words and tune! Focus on parts you don't know by pausing the video after a line to echo the song back.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Listen to another sea shanty (see options in Extra Helpings). How does it feel different or similar? What do you think makes a good "work" song?

WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 9

Wellerman (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of the Wellerman as you can from memory.

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen to the full song once, paying attention to any difficult spots. Then try to sing the song yourself with the karaoke version.

Consider creating your own accompaniment to the song by tapping a rhythm, marching as you sing, etc.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

∞ Video: Wellerman Tune

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: Work Songs

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 10

Wellerman (cont.)

 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP & INTRO

- What did you learn about 19th century work songs last lesson? Do you think we have work songs today?

- Fun fact: in the United States, work songs (like Steal Away and other spirituals) became the roots of what would become jazz and the blues in the 20th century.

→ SING

Can you sing Wellerman from memory now? Listen to the song first before trying, if needed. Feel free to sing with your own accompaniment.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

∞ Video: Wellerman Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Folk Songs

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1	
Enjoy a different take on Wellerman! Discuss how/if the different musical style and/or instruments change the feel of the song. ∞ Video Link: Ragtime Wellerman ∞ Video Link: Symphony Wellerman	
WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 11 Term Recap Materials: Our Work or Music PDF → DISCUSS Which folk song from the term was your favorite? Why? → SING Try and sing both songs from the term acapella (just your voice and your own accompaniment).	
WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Folk Songs	



Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 13

National Anthem

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, and Our Hymns Our Heritage (optional)

PREP: You'll be choosing a national anthem to learn this term. Feel free to pre-select or use this lesson to decide. Consider having students learn their own national anthem (if young and/or unfamiliar with it) or another (pick based on interest and/or degree of challenge since some are obviously not in English).

→ INTRO

The 19th century was a period of turmoil. The last part of the 18th century and first half of the 19th is sometimes called the "Age of Revolutions." There was the American Revolution (1776), the French Revolution (1789), Haitian Revolution (1791) and then the Mexican War of Independence (1810s), uprisings across Latin American (one of the most famous was in Colombia with Simon Bolivar in 1810s), waves of revolutions across continental Europe (including Greece gaining independence from the Ottoman Empire in 1820s), revolts against British rule in India in the 1850s and against the shogunate in Japan in the 1860s (and that isn't all of them!).

Amidst all this upheaval a new genre of folk song rose up - the national anthem. These folk songs gave a sense of shared identity and purpose among disparate peoples. Some sound like hymns, others like military marches, work songs, or even operas. You'll learn one anthem this term but we'll listen to several different ones so you can hear these differences and similarities!

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

- Scroll down playlist to see multiple options or look up a different one if desired.
 - Once you've decided which anthem to learn, listen to the whole thing.
 - Read the words aloud and/or copy them into your Our Work Book or another notebook if needed.
- ∞ Music Links: National Anthems

★ TEACHER NOTE

Students will learn their own (or a different) national anthem this term. This brings many opportunities to talk about healthy (and unhealthy) ways to relate to one's country.

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 14

National Anthem (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the rise of national anthems?

→ SING & PRACTICE

- Listen to your National Anthem of choice to work on the tune. Hum any refrains or repeated parts you start to recognize.
 - Read or listen to the words aloud.
 - Finish copying the words (if applicable) into your notebook.
- ∞ Music Links: National Anthems

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: About National Anthems

★ TEACHER NOTE

Look up sheet music for your anthem of choice if desired to use as an aid in learning the tune, especially if it is one of the more complicated ones! Googling "[Name of anthem] sheet music pdf" is usually successful. Similarly, an audio recording of the lyrics can be helpful if learning an unfamiliar language.



Term 2

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 15

National Anthem (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum part of your anthem from memory?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the whole song. Then try listening to a line, pausing the video, and echoing it back.

∞ Music Links: National Anthems

→ LISTEN (OPTIONAL)

Did you know that the Star Spangled Banner has been the US national anthem for less than a century? Although Francis Scott Key composed the song in 1814, it was not adopted as the national anthem until 1931. Before then, the unofficial anthem was "My Country 'Tis of Thee," which was adapted from the English national anthem, "God Save the Queen." Many other anthems have evolved in a similar way.

∞ Video Link: My Country 'Tis of Thee

• LITERATURE CONNECTION & COMPOSITION (Grades 9+)

W.E.B Du Bois (who you might read more about in Literature lessons) wrote a parody of My Country 'Tis of Thee. Read his poem and the original lyrics and then write a paragraph explaining how W.E.B. Du Bois's poem critiques the original.

∞ Article Link: My Country 'Tis of Thee by W.E.B. Du Bois

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Video Link: God Save the Queen

WEEK 4 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 16

National Anthem (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of your National Anthem as you can from memory.

→ INTRO

In her book *Ourselves*, Charlotte Mason talks about good and bad ways we can show loyalty to our country. It is a good thing when our love for our country makes us seek to understand its history, laws, institutions, people, strengths and weaknesses. We should want to love and care for the place we live and the other people who live around us! It is not good when we use our love for our country as an excuse to look down on other people or countries and ignore our own country's weaknesses. On the other hand, is also unhelpful when we only focus on what is bad about our country. As you sing your national anthem and read the words, think about what kind of love or loyalty the song displays.

→ SING

Try to sing with your recording of choice for the whole song.

∞ Music Links: National Anthems

→ EXPLORE (CHOOSE AN OPTION BELOW)

• Learn the story of the Star Spangled Banner

∞ Article Link: Star Spangled Story

• Listen to other national anthems in your music playlist with any extra time.

→ DISCUSS (GRADES 7+)

Many national anthems ask a god to protect their country (some mean the Christian God revealed in the Bible and others refer to gods of other religions). For instance, the Canadian national anthem includes the prayer, "God, keep our land glorious and free" and the British anthem's name is "God Save the Queen (or King)." What do you think about asking God for protection and preservation of a nation or for wisdom for our leaders? If

★ TEACHER NOTE

See *Ourselves* p.120-121 for more on loyalty to country and peruse High School Citizenship selections for additional teacher resources on this topic. You may also wish to preselect and/or preview national anthems for the related composition assignment.

• COMPOSITION (Grades 7+)

Pick 3-5 national anthems, read their English translations, and discuss the similarities and differences you find. What types of loyalty do you find in each anthem?

∞ National Anthem lyrics

Folk Songs

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

so, is there ever an issue of assuming God is on a particular nation's side? For example, what if two nations are fighting against each other and both asking God to help them win?

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 17

National Anthem (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Explain the national anthem you're learning as if talking about it to a friend who has never heard of it.

→ SING

Perform your anthem acapella (just your voice). Note any problem spots and sing it again with the recording as needed.

∞ Music Links: National Anthems

→ EXPLORE (OPTIONAL)

Listen to other national anthems in your music playlist with any extra time.

• MUSICAL CONNECTION

While national anthems became a new genre of folk songs in the 19th century, other musicians composed new kinds of instrumental music that focused on trying to capture the local flavor and culture of their homelands. One example: Edvard Grieg whom you'll recognize from Composer Study lessons!

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 18

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, colored pencils, or markers

→ RECAP

Sing National Anthem from memory (or look at lyrics if needed). Think about the words and try to sing in a way that matches them!

→ INTRO

We're starting our next folk song today! It's important to remember that even while the big, loud anthems dealing with national events and identity are developing, mothers were still singing to their babies (sometimes even in the midst of those wars or other events). Our folk song the rest of this term is sometimes called Margaret's Song because a girl name Margaret recorded it for the Library of Congress archives. It comes from around the 1830s.

→ STUDY & LISTEN

Read the translation of the song in your Our Work Book/Music PDF and then listen to the lullaby a few times.

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa

★ TEACHER NOTE

If your student(s) learned a national anthem not in English the first part of this term, here is an alternate 19th century lullaby option in English if two folk songs not in English is too much of a stretch. There is a beautiful celtic harp version in the folk song playlist, and a simpler version is linked here.

∞ Video Link: All Through the Night (lyrics below the video)

WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 19

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

Warm up your voice by singing your National Anthem.

→ MAPWORK

Our term's lullaby probably originated about the same time as the Trail of Tears, when President Andrew Jackson signed the Indian Removal Act in 1830 forcing many Native Americans (the Creek, Seminole, Muscogee (Creek), Chickasaw, Choctaw, and Cherokee primarily) who lived in the American Southeast to relocate to what is now Oklahoma. (Remember Wallace Willis who may have authored "Steal Away" from Term 1? He was one of those who had to relocate!). View the Trail of Tears map and read more as desired.

∞ Website Link: Trail of Tears Association

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the trail of tears website for your students before sharing.



Term 2

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen once to the song and follow along with the lyrics in your book. Then listen again and try humming along.

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

- What do you think makes a good lullaby?

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 20

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Warm up your voice and then try singing along with the lullaby this week.

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

→ EXPLORE (OPTIONAL)

Enjoy this Welsh lullaby often sung around Christmas!

∞ Video Link: All Through the Night

WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 21

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, drawing or painting supplies

→ RECAP

Sing as much as you can remember of Margaret's Lullaby without looking at the words.

→ SING & PRACTICE

Sing with the video, pausing after a line to echo it back if needed. Can you sing it by yourself?

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

→ ILLUSTRATE

Draw or paint an illustration to go with Bebi Notsa.

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 22

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Why do you think Bebi Notsa sounds so calming?

→ SING

Use the video if needed to first refresh your memory. Then try to sing the lullaby acapella (using just your voice).

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

→ DISCUSS

If you wrote a second verse to the same tune, what would it be about?

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 23

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Sing both of the term's songs. Think about how to illustrate the words with your voice as you sing.

∞ Music Links: Playlist

Folk Songs

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The term's folk songs.



Term 3

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 25

The San Juan Pig

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ INTRO

Our next folk song is about a real event that happened in 1859 which involves a pig eating forbidden potatoes.

→ READ & SING

Read the story in your Our Work/Music book, then listen to the full song.
∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: About the San Juan Pig
Time Marker: 0:00-2:45

★ TEACHER NOTE

See Extra Helpings for more resources on the Pig War and an alternate recording.

● IMPORTANT DATE

Pig War (1859-1872AD)

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 26

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What is our new folk song about?

→ SING & PRACTICE

- Read the lyrics aloud. There are a lot of words, so after reading the full song, reread just the first verse and work on learning it by heart.
 - Listen to the full song. Try to alternate between listening to a verse and then humming the next as you learn the tune.
- ∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ VIEW

Finish the video about the Pig War.
∞ Video Link: About the San Juan Pig
Time Marker: 2:45 - end

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 27

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, US or Canadian atlas

→ MAPWORK & RECAP

Draw a sketch in your notebook of San Juan Island and the debated borders and straits. Refer to your world atlas or the linked image and label the key places.
∞ Map Link: San Juan Island Map

→ COPY (GRADES 4+)

Write down the first line of each verse to help you remember the flow of the song.

→ SING & PRACTICE

Sing along with the video today. It may be helpful to pause after each line to sing the song back to give equal attention to all the words.
∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio



Term 3

WEEK 4 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 28

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Tell the story of the San Juan Pig (in your own words).

→ SING

- Can you sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics or listening to the audio?
 - Sing along with the audio today for the rest of the song, pausing to repeat any lines you are still working on.
- ∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time or on your own time, sketch or paint an illustration to go with the song.

- **COMPOSITION** (Grades 11-12; Optional Grades 9-10)
Write a research paper on the Pig War. Use the research questions and ideas in the link below to get you started.
- ∞ **Article Link:** Pig War Research Project

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 29

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of the song as you can from memory. Stop when you get to the point you don't remember the words.

→ SING & PRACTICE

- Pick up from where you started forgetting the words and read aloud or sing the rest of the song looking at the lyrics (but no audio).
 - Listen to the full song again and follow along in your head. Note down any places where you need to revisit the words or tune.
- ∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ DISCUSS

The San Juan Pig is written as a sort of ballad (a story-song). If you wrote a ballad, what event (in the present or past) would you write about?

- **EXTRA HELPINGS**
Write your own ballad!

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 30

Aloha 'Oe

Materials: Like a Bird, Our Work or Music PDF, atlas

→ RECAP

Sing The San Juan Pig to warm up your voice and refresh your memory.

→ INTRO & MAPWORK

- Our last folk song takes us from San Juan Island to Hawaii!
- Locate the Hawaiian islands on your atlas.
- This song of farewell between two lovers was written by the last monarch of Hawaii and is her most famous composition. The story goes that queen and her attendants visited a friend on Oahu. Then "as they started their return trip to Honolulu on horseback up the steep Pali trail, the queen turned to admire the view of Kaneohe Bay. She witnessed a particularly affectionate farewell between Colonel James Boyd of her party and a lovely young girl from Maunawili. As they rode up the steep cliff and into the swirling winds, she started to hum this melody weaving words into a romantic song. At the top of the pali, a cloud hung over the mountain peak and slowly floated down Nu'u Valley. The queen continued to hum and completed her song as they rode the winding trail down the valley back to Honolulu."

- **IMPORTANT DATE**
Aloha 'Oe composed (1878AD)



Term 3

∞ Reference Link

→ READ & LISTEN

• Read the lyrics and translation in your Our Work or Music book. and then listen to the full song. Depending on your preference, you can choose to learn the full song or only the first verse and chorus.

∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (Full)

∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (one verse)

∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (one verse with lyrics)

WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 31

Aloha 'Oe

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What was the story behind our new folk song, Aloha 'Oe?

→ VIEW

This is the view the Queen Lili'uokalani might have seen as she began to weave our song in her head. The second image shows the flower/tree mentioned at the end of the first verse.

∞ Image Link: Nu'uauu Pali

∞ Image Link: Metrosideros polymorpha

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

• Listen to the full song and pay close attention to the pronunciation of the words. Make notes as needed to help you remember.

• Listen to the song again and focus on the tune. Start humming or hooing along as you pick up the melody.

∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (recording of choice)

→ EXPLORE

If time allows, learn a bit more about Hawaii's last queen (scroll through the page).

∞ Website Link: About Queen Lili'uokalani

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 32

Aloha 'Oe

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum or sing the chorus of Aloha 'Oe from memory?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Sing along with your recording of choice, pausing the video to echo back a line as needed.

∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (recording of choice)

→ EXPLORE

If time allows, learn a bit more about Hawaii's last queen (scroll through the page).

∞ Website Link: About Queen Lili'uokalani

WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 33

Aloha 'Oe (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

How much of the song can you sing?



Term 3

→ SING

Sing along with the recording and note any spots that need more work.
∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (recording of choice)

→ LISTEN

Queen Lili'uokalani wrote a song which became the national anthem of Hawaii for a time. How is it different from or similar to the anthems you heard last term?

∞ Video Link: He Mele Lāhui Hawai'i

- How would you describe the mood of this song? Why?
- Over the years, people have come to see this song as a symbolic sad farewell from the queen to her people. How does this fit with the mood you described?

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 34

Aloha 'Oe (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, painting or sketching supplies (optional)

→ RECAP

Do you remember the words to "The San Juan Pig"?

→ SING

Sing "Aloha 'Oe" from memory, then listen to the video to check your work.

∞ Video Link: Aloha 'Oe

- If you learned Angels We Have Heard on High in hymn lessons, do you notice any similarities between the two songs? [They both have two languages! The fancy name is that these are both "macaronic" songs.]

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time, sketch or paint an illustration to go with this song.

• TERMINOLOGY

macaronic songs: songs (often folk songs) that contain two languages in the same song.

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 35

Term Recap

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Make sure to stand when you sing and do a few warm-ups to get your voice ready. Sing both folk songs from the term (maybe even try singing one from earlier in the year too!).

→ DISCUSS

Look back at your Our Work/Music book and discuss your favorite folk songs from the year.

WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Folk Songs

Folk Songs

Examination

- Term 1** · Tell the names and what you remember about the two folk songs you learned this term. Then pick one and sing it!
- Term 2** · Sing Bebi Notsa OR your national anthem.
- Term 3** · Sing Aloha 'Oe OR The San Juan Pig and tell the story behind one of the songs.